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MOODMAP

Senior Project in Digital Media

IDM NYU | Spring 2026 | Gannis

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Project Statement

ABOUT

MoodMap is an interactive map where people share how they feel in different places. The project reflects on how spaces affect our feelings and how many of us experience similar emotions in the same places.



ELEVATOR PITCH

A shared map that visualizes how people feel in different places.

HASHTAGS

#EmotionalMap #SharedFeelings #Emographics

Project Statement

DESCRIPTION

MoodMap is a project about making emotions visible in the places where they are felt. The motivation comes from noticing how much emotion is experienced privately in public spaces, and how rarely those shared patterns are seen. Cities are full of overlapping feelings like stress, comfort, loneliness, and excitement, yet they often remain invisible. MoodMap aims to surface these emotional layers to encourage reflection, empathy, and awareness of how environments shape our daily experiences.

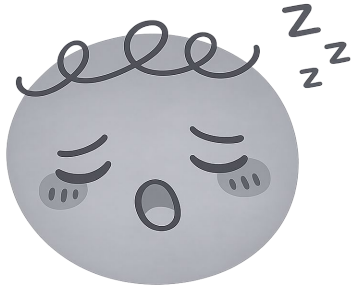
The project takes the form of an interactive map where users can input how they feel at a specific location. Each entry appears on the map as part of a collective emotional landscape, allowing patterns to emerge over time. Inspired by projects that combine location-based data with social awareness, MoodMap focuses not on events or behavior, but on feeling. The project explores how emotions connect to place and how simple inputs can communicate shared experiences.

Project Statement

DESCRIPTION

MoodMap is designed specifically for young urban residents who live, study, or work in dense city environments and already use their phones as tools for reflection, navigation, and social awareness. It values accessibility and emotional safety by keeping contributions simple and anonymous.

The project will be developed using a map-based interface where users allow location access to share how they feel in a place. MoodMap uses a limited set of emotion categories to keep interactions simple. The development process includes prototyping the interface, testing how emotions appear on the map, and refining the design through usability feedback.



Proclamation

My creative practice comes from paying attention to how people move through the world and how they feel in different places. I am drawn to quiet moments, shared spaces, and experiences that often go unnoticed. I am interested in how technology can create **space for reflection, not distraction.**

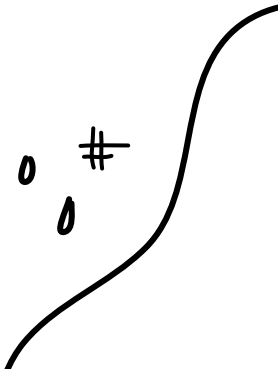
I believe meaningful digital experiences should be:

SIMPLE

An experience should be easy to use, easy to understand, and open to people from different emotional and social backgrounds.

HUMAN

Design should respect emotional complexity and avoid forcing people into categories or conclusions. It should leave room for interpretation.



Proclamation

REFLECTIVE

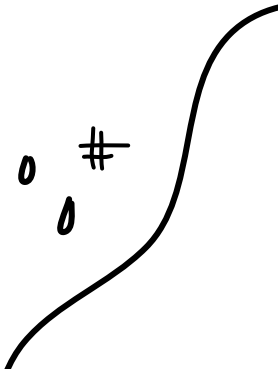
I value tools that help people pause and notice patterns, both in themselves and in the world around them.

MINDFUL

Design should avoid performative sharing and reduce pressure, allowing people to participate in ways that feel comfortable.

SAFE

An experience should protect privacy and allow people to share without feeling exposed.



Mantra



“Trust the process”

Motivation

This project exists because emotions shape how we experience places, even though they are often unseen. MoodMap matters to me because it turns something I already notice into a shared, visual experience that reveals emotional patterns and helps public spaces feel less isolating.

I am doing this project to explore how emotions connect to place and routine. By mapping feelings over time, I want to see what patterns emerge and how emotions take shape when viewed together. The project does not aim to fix emotion, but to offer a quiet, reflective experience.

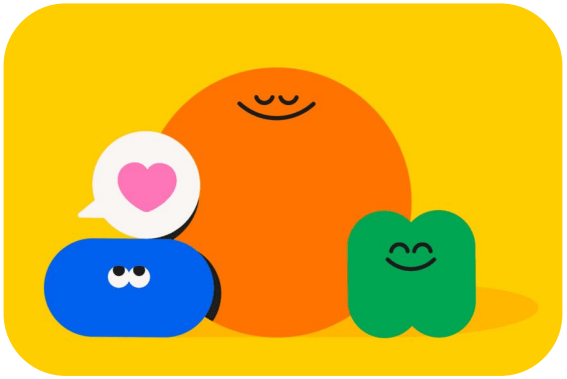


I feel confident committing to this project because I have a **technical background** in computer science and a **design background** in user interfaces and digital experiences.

Influences



EMMO



HEADSPACE



FINCH

Target Audience

This project is designed specifically for young urban residents (ages 18–30) who live, study, or work in dense city environments and already use their phones as tools for reflection, navigation, and social awareness.



- College students and early-career professionals
- People who move through the city daily
- Emotionally aware individuals who do not always have structured reflections

What will they experience?

1. A brief pause for **emotional self-awareness**
2. Recognition that emotions are shared, not isolated
3. The **city reimagined** through collective feeling

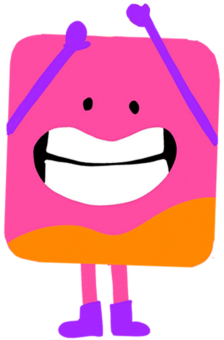
Personas

Overstimulated Student (20)



- Moves around campus daily
- **Often stressed,** rarely reflects intentionally
- Wants to **notice emotional patterns** and feel less alone

Early Career Professional (24)



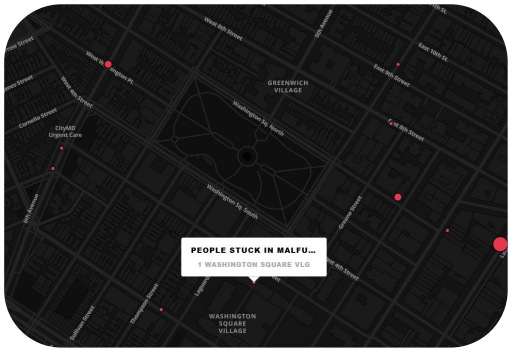
- Commutes, long hours
- **Likes data,** skeptical of wellness apps
- Uses the map to **identify stress hotspots**

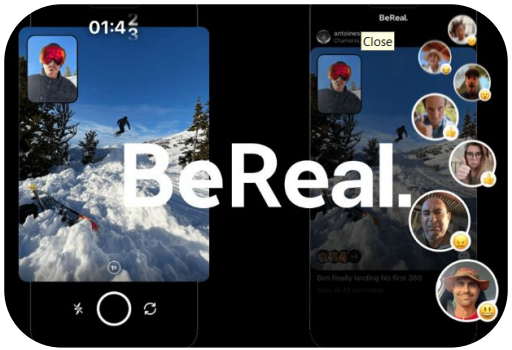
Observer (22)

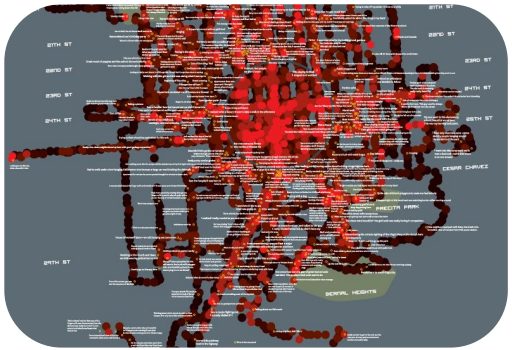


- Emotionally aware
- **Curious about how others experience** the same spaces
- Contextualizes emotions socially, not personally

Related Projects







Citizen

- Safety alerts & incident map driven by reports
- **Difference:** focus is emotional atmosphere, not crime/safety; non-alarmist

BeReal

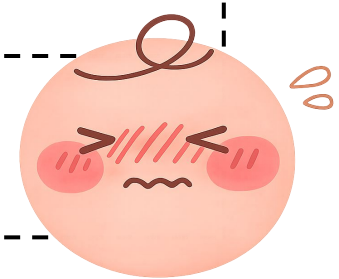
- Daily prompt; quick, time-limited posting
- **Difference:** anonymous emotional data, not social posting

BioMapping

- Uses physiological sensors & GPS to map emotional responses
- **Difference:** lightweight daily participation

Resources

Usability Feedback (UAT)	Supervisor (concept & critique)	Peers (UX, ethics & clarity)	5–10 peer testers (students / young professionals)	Me ;)
Technical Requirements	Leaflet (map visualization)	GitHub (deployment & hosting)	Figma (UI design)	Firebase (cloud database)
Supplies	Monitor	Laptop	Internet	
Spaces	Public campus spaces (testing environments)	City streets & transit areas		



Project Milestones

RESEARCH

Explore related work in data visualization and software tools for development.

VISUAL DIRECTION

Define the mood and tone through color and playful character design.

WIREFRAMES

Design the layout and flow for adding emotions and exploring the map.



Project Milestones

PROTOTYPE

Build an early version using placeholder data to test core features and flow.

ITERATION

Refine visuals and improve usability based on feedback from user testing.

BACKEND INTEGRATION

Connect the system to store and manage real user inputs.



Ideation & Research

01 An emotional tracker that records how different places make users feel

02 A social platform for daily emotional check-ins shared with close friends

03 A journal that tracks emotional patterns over time

04 A food discovery tool that helps users decide what to eat

05 A comfort food journal where users log meals tied to emotions

06 A narrative choice-based game about feeling homesick

07 An online dating app designed for dogs and their owners

08 A productivity tool that tracks emotional energy instead of tasks

09 An archive of comfort items such as food smells or familiar objects

10 An emotional AI pet companion that reacts to the user's mood

Ideation & Research

11 A digital dining experience that simulates eating through sound and visuals

12 A subway review app that captures emotional experiences of different lines

13 A medical reminder app for elderly users to manage daily medications

14 An immersive interactive experience about Thai culture

15 An interactive experience of NYC told through sound, smell, and touch

16 A dream tracking journal for recording & reflecting on dreams

17 A fridge tracking tool that shows what is expired and suggests what to cook

18 A packing assistance tool that helps users prepare for trips

19 A tool for people who are often late that tracks time loss

20 A drawing-based emotion journal for visual expression

Emotion	Identity	Relationship	Food
Happy	Pride	Love	Craving
Angry	Belonging	Friendship	Comfort
Sad	Independent	Family	Flavorful
Lonely	Home	Work	Dining
Exhausted	Personality	Connection	Cooking
Time	Culture	Trust	Ingredients
Experience	Memory	Support	Taste
Reaction	Choice	Communication	Smell

Idea Cards

Home	Happy	Belonging	Lonely
Cooking	Sad	Connection	Independent
Comfort	Connection	Friendship	Home
Taste	Time	Experience	Support
Memory	Reaction	Culture	Experience

Design



Happy



Loving



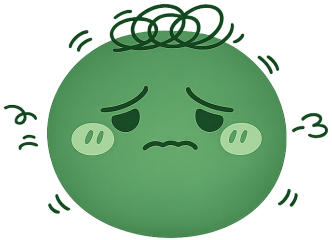
Sad



Annoyed



Angry



Anxious



Calm



Tired

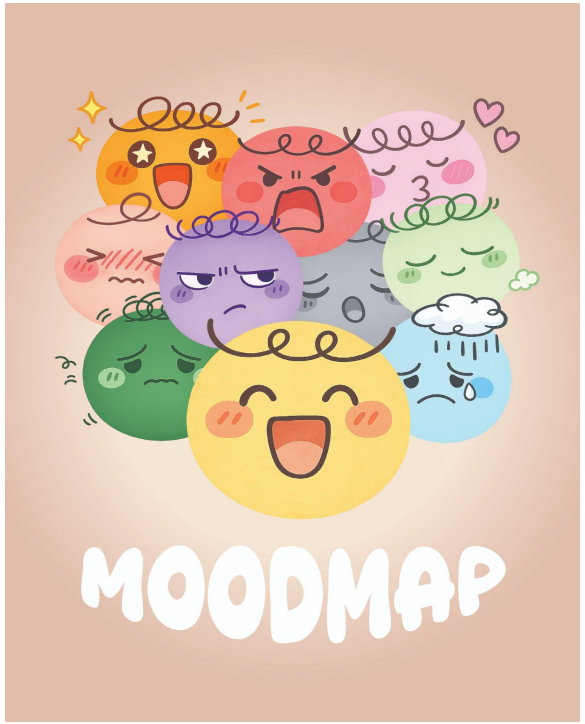


Embarrassed



Excited

Design


MOODMAP


I<3
DM
Integrated
Design & Media
SHOWCASE


I<3
DM
Integrated
Design & Media
SHOWCASE

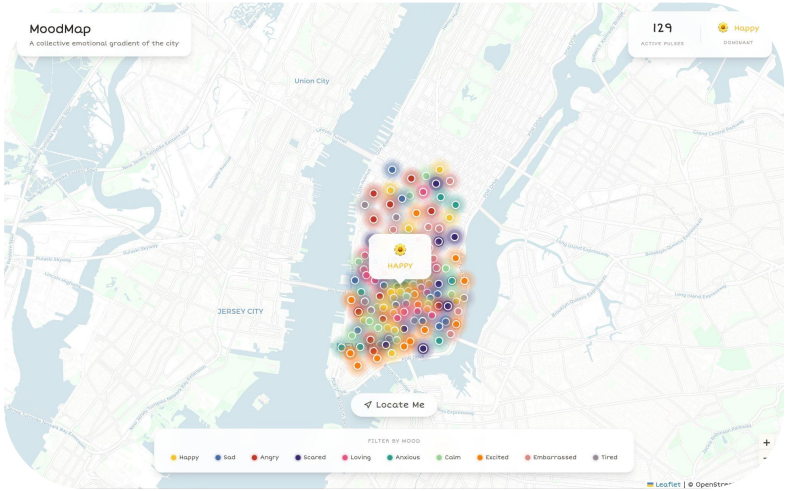
Design

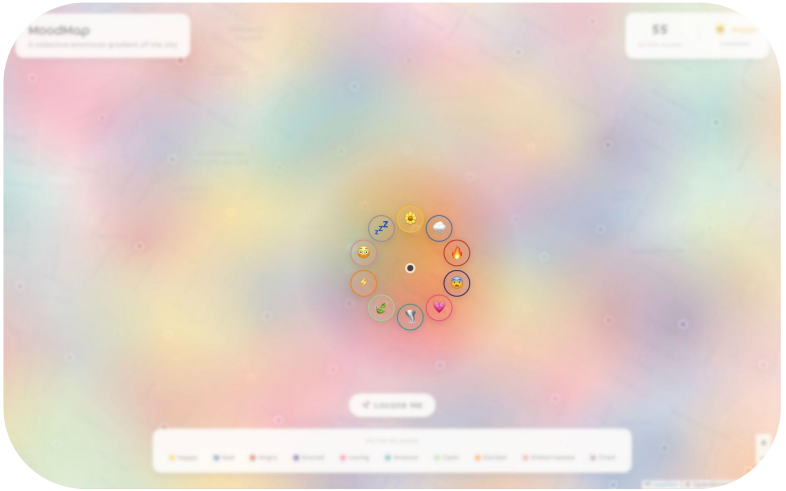


Teaser



Demo Day



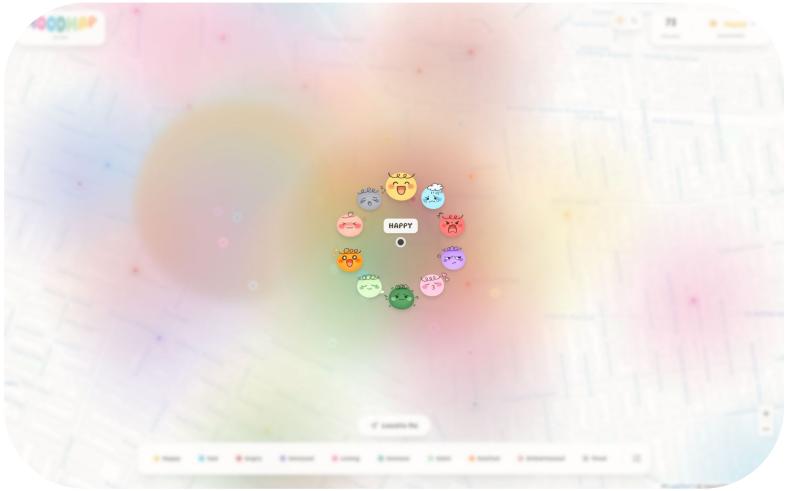


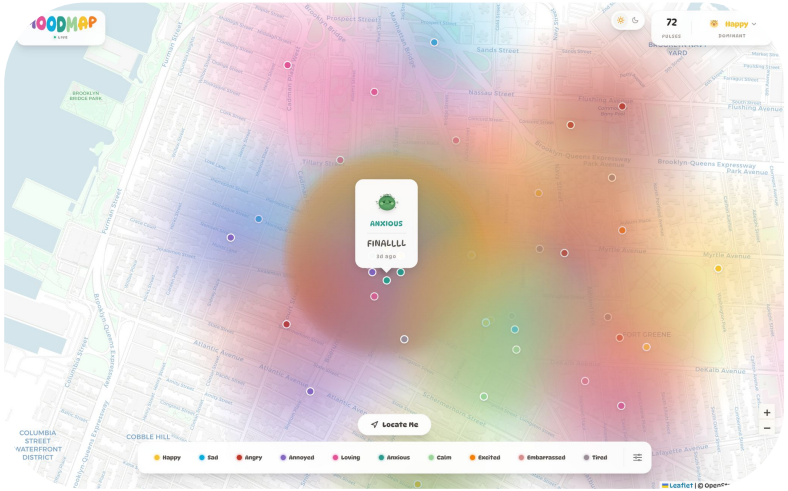
[Prototype]

[Padlet]

Development

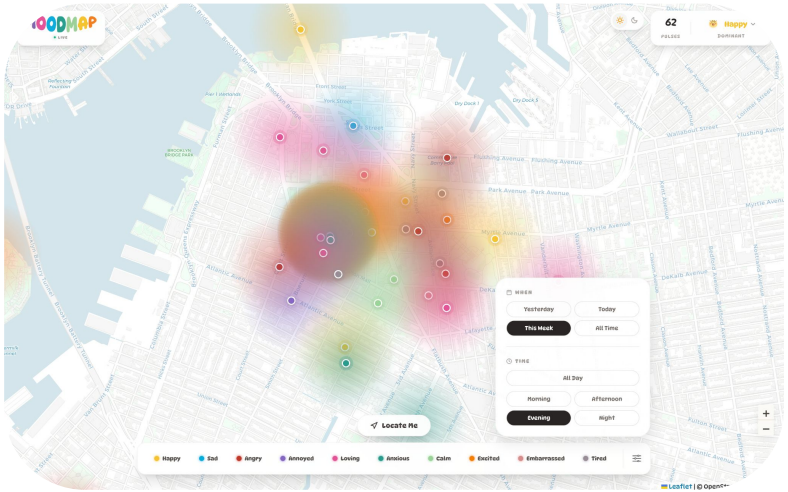
GitHub



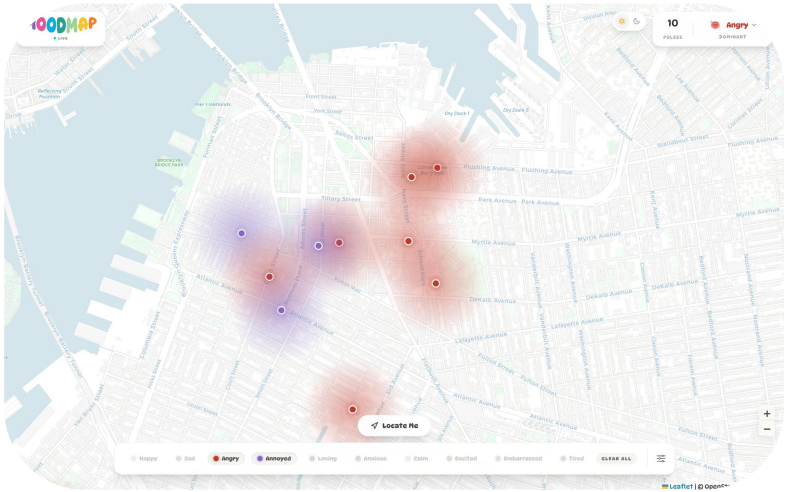


MoodMap

Development

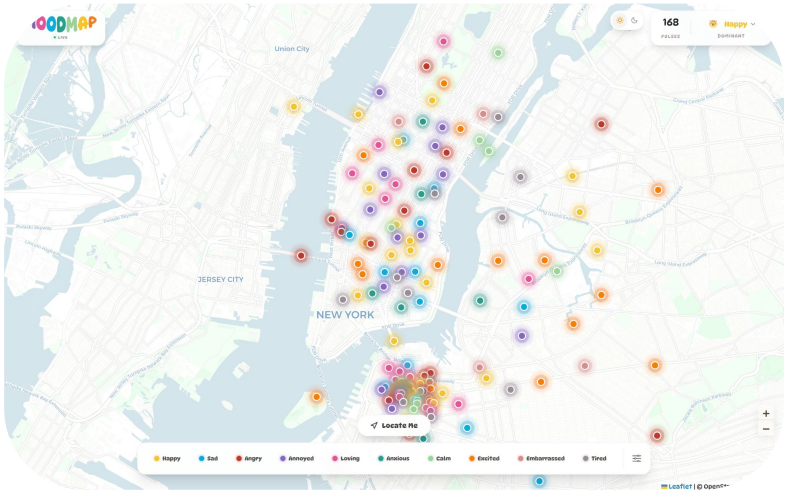


Filter by Time

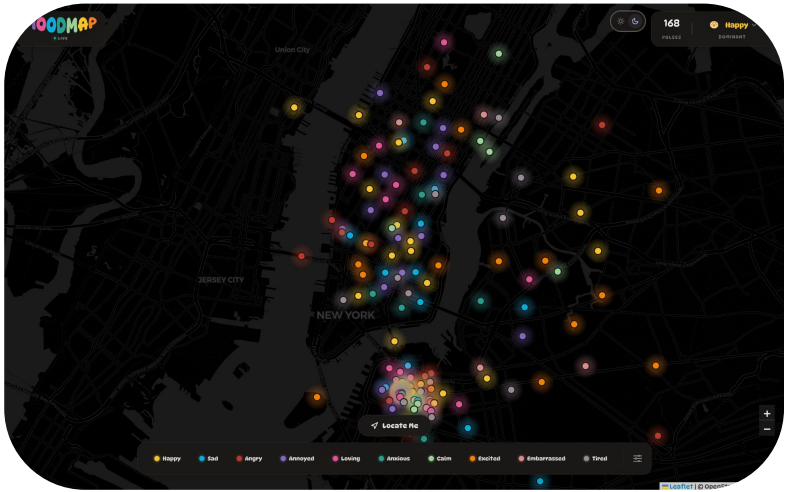


Filter by Mood

Development



Light



Dark

Feasibility Checks



M - MUST HAVE

- Simple emotion selection
- Approximate, privacy-safe location capture
- Shared map that shows emotional patterns



S - SHOULD HAVE

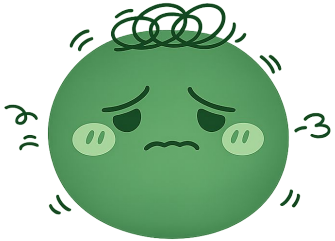
- Time-based filters (today / yesterday / week)
- Visual clustering or heatmap smoothing
- Audio snippets attached to emotions

Feasibility Checks



C - COULD HAVE

- Short contextual tags (e.g., “crowded,” “quiet”)
- Emotion trend summaries (e.g., “city mood today”)
- Calm / stress discovery mode



W - WON’T HAVE

- Likes, comments, followers, or social feeds
- Mental health diagnoses or advice
- Ads, monetization, or data resale



Thank You!